

Song

From earliest times, people have sung songs for entertainment, while at work, and even to soothe babies. “Folk” songs, many ancient in origin, are often performed unaccompanied, while “art” songs may be accompanied by piano or guitar to help bring out the underlying meaning of the words.



△ French mélodie

Ravel's "*Chanson Française*" is a *mélodie* (art song) based on a popular French song. The pleasing tune in triple time has a simple, largely chordal piano accompaniment.

REAL WORLD

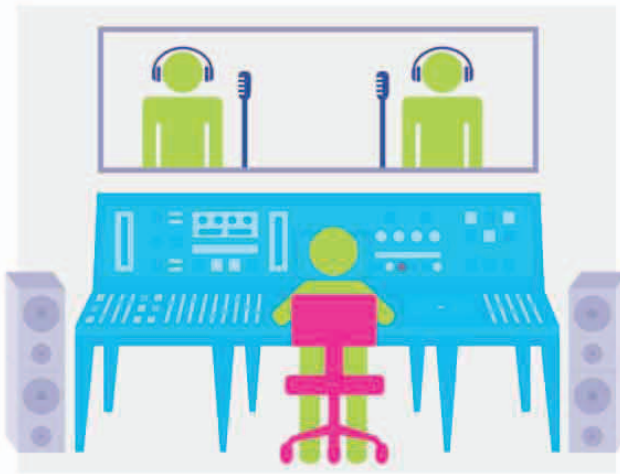
Schubert and Heine

Composers generally enjoy setting words that are descriptive and expressive. In the German poet Heinrich Heine's (1797–1856) poetry, Franz Schubert (1797–1828) found a rich source of inspiration and texts for many of his 630 songs *Lieder* songs.



Music for film and television

Music for the screen sets the atmosphere, time, and place, and moves the action forward. It can also describe a character, add drama, and provide continuity. Most of this is “background” music, underlining what happens on the screen. Music contained within the action—for example, someone singing—is known as “diegetic.”



△ Recording studio

Operated from a single desk, a range of interconnected technologies can be manipulated by a skilled engineer to create remarkable results.

Modern listening

Recording began in the 1860s. It has since grown into a huge industry and has transformed the way we listen—bringing music on record or disk to the masses, without the need for live performance. Thanks to new technologies, we can now listen to any music we choose, at any time, anywhere.



△ Going it alone

The recent phenomenon of “solo” listening would surprise audiences of earlier centuries, accustomed to the collective experience of attending a concert.